Gabo Esquivel

Senior AI Product Engineer

I build AI-powered applications with voice, chat, retrieval, and tool integration, including the interfaces and administration tools needed to operate them. My work combines hands-on AI engineering with 15+ years of web, mobile, and backend development using TypeScript, React, React Native, and cloud infrastructure. Fluent in English, Spanish, Portuguese, and Italian.

Highlights

- Built LegalAgent's bilingual voice and chat assistant using OpenAI Realtime API, AI SDK, and RAG
- Developed retrieval and research tools for Bitlauncher's AI assistant
- Built specialized AI assistant interfaces and automated internationalization at Masterbots
- Led engineering for Wink, Costa Rica's first neobank, from architecture to launch

Experience

Software Engineer, LegalAgent

Remote • Contract • 2025

AI legal software combining bilingual voice, chat, document retrieval, and internal administration tools.

- Built a voice and chat assistant in React Native and Expo using the Vercel AI SDK and OpenAI Realtime API.
- Implemented retrieval-augmented generation for legal case context, document summaries, and procedural guidance.
- Developed bilingual voice interactions with realtime transcription and speech synthesis.
- Built a TanStack Start administration dashboard with Microsoft SSO, prompt management, and document categorization.
- Refined the assistant's persona and tool-calling behavior using feedback from attorneys.

Product Engineer, Bitlauncher

Remote • Full-time • Nov 2023 – Nov 2025

AI and crypto launchpad with retrieval, research tools, and specialized assistant integrations.

- Led product direction and engineering while remaining hands-on in implementation.
- Built an AI assistant with RAG and tools for news and YouTube research.
- Integrated Masterbots prompting and AI-assisted internationalization workflows.

Software Engineer, Opyn

Remote • Contract • Oct 2024 – Feb 2025

Opyn Markets perpetuals trading interface on Arbitrum, with integrated wallets and indexed blockchain data.

- Prototyped an LLM assistant for onboarding and support.

Lead Engineer, Bitcash

Remote • Part-time • Jan 2020 – Jul 2021

Cryptocurrency and stablecoin exchange with peer-to-peer trading, realtime messaging, and browser-based signing.

- Built the React, Vite, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Hasura, and Google Cloud stack.
- Built the peer-to-peer exchange, realtime chat, and matching engine.
- Built WebAuthn key management for in-browser transaction signing without an external wallet.

Lead Engineer, Wink

On-site • Full-time • Apr 2015 – Mar 2018

Lead-engineering role on Wink's React Native mobile application, AWS backend, and partner-bank integrations.

- Built the first version of Wink's React Native mobile application and AWS backend.
- Selected the initial technology stack and established the application architecture.
- Integrated partner-bank APIs for deposits, transfers, and account information.
- Implemented biometric identity verification and authentication through a React Native native bridge.
- Helped establish the engineering team responsible for the product's launch.

Additional experience

My broader engineering experience includes Bitlauncher's auctions and blockchain integrations (2023–2025), Opyn's trading application (2024–2025), ZTX's WebGL wallet integration (2022–2023), and RareMint's NFT marketplace (2021–2022). Earlier work includes EOS Costa Rica (2018–2020), Emanate (2019–2020), AMC Networks (2012–2014), and American Express (2010–2012).

Connect

Open to direct hire, international hire, or contracting through Blockmatic Labs LLC. Cannot work under W-2. Based in Costa Rica, working US Mountain Time. Fluent in English, Spanish, Portuguese, and Italian.

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The rest of the work is on gaboesquivel.com.